

D259

Professional Practice Experience II: Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A coding department must code 9,600 outpatient records each month. The standard is 3 records per hour, and one FTE works 160 productive hours a month. The team moved to remote work last spring, and the previous manager used a target of 4 records per hour. How many FTE coders are needed?

- A. 15 FTEs
- B. 20 FTEs
- C. 60 FTEs
- D. 22 FTEs, adding two to cover remote-work overhead

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team of 12 FTE coders, each working 160 productive hours a month, codes exactly 7,680 records a month. What is the productivity rate per coder per hour?

- A. 640 records per hour
- B. 4 records per hour
- C. 0.25 records per hour
- D. 48 records per hour

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

3.

A cardiologist at an unaffiliated hospital who is now treating a patient asks the HIM department for the patient's recent discharge summary and echo report. The request arrived late on a Friday afternoon, and the patient is a well-known local business owner. Under the HIPAA Privacy Rule, what is required before release?

- A. A court order or subpoena.
- B. Written permission from the patient because of their public profile.
- C. No patient authorization; disclosure for treatment is permitted after verifying the requester per policy.
- D. A signed patient authorization.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these requests requires a signed patient authorization before the hospital may release records?

- A.** Any request from outside the hospital walls.
- B.** The hospital's own quality committee reviewing care.
- C.** The patient's health plan processing a claim for the stay.
- D.** A life insurance company reviewing the patient's application for a new policy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A hospital averages 1,200 discharges a month. Today there are 450 incomplete records, of which 180 are past the medical staff deadline and are delinquent. The hospital recently passed its accreditation survey. What is the delinquent record rate?

- A.** 37.5%
- B.** 0%, since the survey found the hospital compliant
- C.** 15%
- D.** 40%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A facility sets a goal that its delinquent record rate stay at or below 10%. It averages 900 discharges a month. What is the maximum number of delinquent records it can have and still meet the goal?

- A.** 90
- B.** 810
- C.** 9
- D.** 10

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A coder who has the highest accuracy score on the team has arrived late three times this month. The supervisor gave a documented verbal warning two weeks ago, and the coder has since been late again. The coder also volunteers to train new hires. Under a standard progressive discipline policy, what is the next step?

- A. Take no action because the coder's accuracy and training help are valuable.
- B. Terminate the coder immediately.
- C. Give another verbal reminder without writing anything down.
- D. Issue a written warning and discuss expectations, documenting the meeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A release-of-information supervisor tested a new request-logging checklist with two clerks for one month and then compared results with the prior quarter. Average turnaround fell from 9 days to 5 days. Both clerks have more than ten years of seniority. In the PDCA cycle, what should the supervisor do next?

- A. Act: standardize the checklist and extend it to the rest of the team, then keep monitoring.
- B. Plan: write a new aim statement and start over.
- C. Keep checking for a full year before making any decision.
- D. Credit the clerks' seniority and drop the checklist.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Each month an HIM manager compares coding audit results with the department's 95% accuracy standard and schedules retraining for any coder who falls below it. The manager also chairs the hospital's employee wellness committee. Which management function is this?

- A. Leading, because the manager leads a committee
- B. Controlling
- C. Organizing
- D. Planning

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A patient writes to the hospital saying her allergy list wrongly shows a penicillin allergy. She filed an unrelated billing complaint with patient relations last year. The attending physician reviews the request and agrees the entry is wrong. How should the HIM department correct the record?

- A.** Delete the incorrect entry so no one sees it again.
- B.** Accept every patient amendment request automatically.
- C.** Append or link the amendment to the entry and flag the original as corrected, without erasing it.
- D.** Route it to patient relations as a new complaint.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A batch of paper records has passed its ten-year retention period and is scheduled for shredding by a bonded vendor next week. Legal counsel has just issued a litigation hold on records for one patient in the batch. The vendor offers a discount for larger loads. What should the HIM manager do?

- A.** Add more boxes to the batch to earn the discount.
- B.** Shred the whole batch because the retention period has expired.
- C.** Stop all destruction for every record in the facility.
- D.** Pull the held patient's records and keep them until counsel releases the hold; destroy the rest per schedule with documentation.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Records have passed their retention period, and no legal hold applies. What must accompany their destruction?

- A.** A certificate or log of destruction listing records, date, method, and who witnessed it, kept permanently.
- B.** A new legal hold notice.
- C.** Signed consent from each patient.
- D.** Nothing; expired records can go in regular recycling.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A coding department must code 9,600 outpatient records each month. The standard is 3 records per hour, and one FTE works 160 productive hours a month. ~~The team moved to remote work last spring, and the previous manager used a target of 4 records per hour.~~ How many FTE coders are needed?

Target word: FTEs needed **Decides:** Capacity per FTE = $3 \times 160 = 480$ records a month.

A	Wrong stem number	Uses the old 4-per-hour target instead of the current standard.
B	Correct	$9,600 / (3 \times 160) = 9,600 / 480 = 20$.
C	Dropped element	$9,600 / 160$ leaves out the 3-per-hour productivity rate.
D	Camouflage	The remote setting is not part of the calculation; the standard already defines output.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A team of 12 FTE coders, each working 160 productive hours a month, codes exactly 7,680 records a month. What is the productivity rate per coder per hour?

Target word: solve for the per-hour rate **Decides:** Total hours = $12 \times 160 = 1,920$.

A	Adjacent category	$7,680 / 12$ is records per coder per month, not per hour.
B	Correct	$7,680 / 1,920$ hours = 4.
C	Inverted operation	$1,920 / 7,680$ flips the ratio (hours per record).
D	Dropped element	$7,680 / 160$ ignores that 12 coders share the work.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A cardiologist at an unaffiliated hospital who is now treating a patient asks the HIM department for the patient's recent discharge summary and echo report. ~~The request arrived late on a Friday afternoon, and the patient is a well-known local business owner.~~ Under the HIPAA Privacy Rule, what is required before release?

Target word: authorization requirement **Decides:** The purpose is treatment by a provider.

A	Confusion set	Legal process applies to judicial requests, not continuing care.
B	Camouflage	Public prominence may call for extra monitoring but does not change the treatment rule.
C	Correct	Treatment is one of the TPO purposes that do not need authorization.
D	Adjacent category	Authorization is needed for non-TPO purposes, not provider-to-provider treatment.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

Which of these requests requires a signed patient authorization before the hospital may release records?

Target word: reverse: find the non-TPO disclosure **Decides:** Underwriting by a life insurer is not treatment, payment, or operations.

A	Absolute language	Many outside disclosures (treatment, payment) are permitted without authorization.
B	Adjacent category	Quality review is health care operations.
C	Confusion set	Payment is TPO.
D	Correct	Not a TPO purpose; authorization is required.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A hospital averages 1,200 discharges a month. Today there are 450 incomplete records, of which 180 are past the medical staff deadline and are delinquent. ~~The hospital recently passed its accreditation survey.~~ What is the delinquent record rate?

Target word: delinquent rate **Decides:** Only the 180 past-deadline records are delinquent; base is average monthly discharges.

A	Wrong stem number	450 / 1,200 uses all incomplete records.
B	Camouflage	The survey result does not change today's count.
C	Correct	$180 / 1,200 \times 100 = 15\%$.
D	Adjacent category	180 / 450 divides by incomplete records instead of discharges.

6. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

A facility sets a goal that its delinquent record rate stay at or below 10%. It averages 900 discharges a month. What is the maximum number of delinquent records it can have and still meet the goal?

Target word: solve for delinquent count **Decides:** 10% of 900.

A	Correct	$0.10 \times 900 = 90$.
B	Inverted operation	$900 - 90$ gives records not delinquent.
C	Confusion set	Uses 1% instead of 10%.
D	Wrong stem number	Treats the percentage as a count.

7. Answer D Concept 4

A coder ~~who has the highest accuracy score on the team~~ has arrived late three times this month. The supervisor gave a documented verbal warning two weeks ago, and the coder has since been late again. ~~The coder also volunteers to train new hires.~~ Under a standard progressive discipline policy, what is the next step?

Target word: next discipline step **Decides:** A documented verbal warning already occurred for the same issue.

A	Camouflage	Performance strengths do not excuse policy violations; inconsistency invites claims of unfairness.
B	Absolute language	Skips steps for a routine attendance issue.
C	Dropped element	Omits documentation and escalation.
D	Correct	The next step after a verbal warning is a written warning.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A release-of-information supervisor tested a new request-logging checklist with two clerks for one month and then compared results with the prior quarter. Average turnaround fell from 9 days to 5 days. ~~Both clerks have more than ten years of seniority.~~ In the PDCA cycle, what should the supervisor do next?

Target word: next PDCA phase **Decides:** The pilot is done (Do) and measured (Check).

A	Correct	After a successful Check, Act adopts and spreads the change.
B	Confusion set	Planning already happened; the change worked.
C	Absolute language	Sets an arbitrary rule; clear results support acting now while monitoring.
D	Camouflage	Seniority was the same before and after the change.

9. Answer B Concept 6

Each month an HIM manager compares coding audit results with the department's 95% accuracy standard and schedules retraining for any coder who falls below it. ~~The manager also chairs the hospital's employee wellness committee.~~ Which management function is this?

Target word: which function **Decides:** Measuring against a standard and correcting.

A	Camouflage	The committee role is unrelated to the audit activity.
B	Correct	Controlling compares performance to standards and corrects gaps.
C	Confusion set	Organizing arranges structure and resources.
D	Adjacent category	Setting the 95% standard was planning; checking against it is controlling.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A patient writes to the hospital saying her allergy list wrongly shows a penicillin allergy. ~~She filed an unrelated billing complaint with patient relations last year.~~ The attending physician reviews the request and agrees the entry is wrong. How should the HIM department correct the record?

Target word: how to correct **Decides:** The amendment was accepted by the author; the original must be preserved.

A	Dropped element	Omits preserving the original entry, which breaks record integrity.
B	Absolute language	Facilities may deny requests when the record is accurate and complete.
C	Correct	Integrity requires preserving the original with the correction clearly linked.
D	Camouflage	The past complaint is unrelated; this is an amendment request.

11. Answer D Concept 8

A batch of paper records has passed its ten-year retention period and is scheduled for shredding by a bonded vendor next week. Legal counsel has just issued a litigation hold on records for one patient in the batch. ~~The vendor offers a discount for larger loads.~~ What should the HIM manager do?

Target word: destroy or hold **Decides:** A legal hold suspends destruction for the affected records.

A	Camouflage	Pricing does not decide what may be destroyed.
B	Inverted operation	Lets the schedule override the hold.
C	Absolute language	The hold covers the named records, not everything.
D	Correct	The hold overrides the schedule only for the records it covers.

12. Answer A Concept 8 • transfer

Records have passed their retention period, and no legal hold applies. What must accompany their destruction?

Target word: destruction documentation **Decides:** Destruction is documented permanently.

A	Correct	Standard practice documents what was destroyed and how.
B	Inverted operation	A hold prevents destruction; it does not authorize it.
C	Adjacent category	Consent governs disclosure, not scheduled destruction.
D	Dropped element	Leaves out both secure methods and documentation.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	4	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Staffing from productivity standards	FTEs needed = workload volume / (units per hour × productive hours per FTE).	Dividing volume by hours alone and forgetting the per-hour productivity rate.	A monthly volume, a units-per-hour standard, and hours per FTE in one stem.
2	Disclosures permitted without authorization	HIPAA permits disclosure for treatment, payment, and health care operations without patient authorization; most other uses (e.g., insurers underwriting, employers) need a signed authorization.	Requiring an authorization for every release, or none at all.	Who is asking and why: a treating provider vs. a third party with a non-care purpose.
3	Delinquent record rate	Delinquent rate = delinquent records / average monthly discharges × 100; incomplete records that are not yet past the deadline are not delinquent.	Counting all incomplete records as delinquent, or dividing by the wrong base.	Both an incomplete count and a delinquent count appear with average discharges.
4	Progressive discipline	Discipline escalates in documented steps (verbal, written, suspension, termination) applied consistently, unless the offense is severe.	Skipping steps for a routine issue, or excusing a strong performer.	A repeat of a minor, already-documented problem.
5	PDCA / PDSA improvement cycle	Plan the change, Do it on a small scale, Check results against baseline, Act to standardize (or adjust) and spread.	Restarting planning or re-piloting after results already show success.	A pilot has run and been measured; the question asks what comes next.
6	Functions of management	Planning sets goals; organizing arranges people and resources; leading motivates and directs; controlling measures performance against standards and corrects.	Calling any monitoring activity planning or leading.	Comparing actual results to a standard and taking corrective action.
7	Record amendment and integrity	Patients may request amendment; the facility reviews with the author and, if accepted, appends or links the correction while preserving the original entry.	Deleting or overwriting the original, or treating the request as automatically granted.	A patient disputes an entry in the legal health record.
8	Retention, destruction, and legal hold	Records are destroyed only per the retention schedule, with documentation of destruction; a legal hold suspends destruction for the affected records.	Destroying held records because the retention period has passed.	An expired retention period and pending litigation in the same stem.

Course scope (public description): The PPE II: Management course allows you to experience your future profession at the supervisory level. Any site where health information is used, and you can be mentored by a department or facility manager is appropriate for PPE II. This course is eligible for an In Progress grade. Please see

the Grading Scale Policy for more information.